

INFORMATIVE WRITING

Structure and Organisation

Informative texts are written to inform, explain or describe a topic clearly and accurately.

A strong structure helps your readers understand and remember the information.

THE INFORMATIVE STRUCTURE

Most informative texts follow a clear and logical structure to present information in a way that is easy to follow.

1 TITLE

A clear and specific title tells the reader what the text is about.

TIP: Make it interesting and informative!

2 INTRODUCTION

Introduces the topic and gives the reader a general overview. It may include a definition, interesting fact or brief background information.

TIP: Grab the reader's attention!

3 SEQUENCED ORGANISED INFORMATION

Presents the main ideas and supporting details in a logical order. This could be in order of time, steps in a process, cause and effect, or from general to specific.

TIP: Use paragraphs and subheadings to group related information.

4 FACTS, EXAMPLES AND EVIDENCE

Includes facts, data, statistics, examples, quotes or expert opinions to support the information.

TIP: Accurate and reliable sources make your writing trustworthy.

5 CONCLUSION

Summarises the key points and may end with a final thought, prediction or call to action.

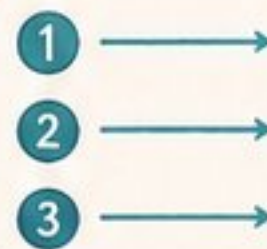
TIP: Leave the reader with something to think about.

6 REFERENCES (IF NEEDED)

A list of the sources you used to research your information.

TIP: Use a consistent referencing style.

WAYS TO ORGANISE INFORMATION



SEQUENTIAL ORDER

Presents information in time order or step-by-step.

Example: The life cycle of a butterfly.



CAUSE AND EFFECT

Explains why something happens and what results from it.

Example: Causes and effects of deforestation.



GENERAL TO SPECIFIC

Gives broad information first, then more detailed facts.

Example: From ocean habitats to coral reefs.



DESCRIPTIVE ORDER

Describes the parts, features or qualities of a topic.

Example: Features of a volcano.

ORGANISATION TIPS

- ✓ Plan your writing before you start.
- ✓ Use headings and subheadings.
- ✓ Group related ideas into paragraphs.
- ✓ Use linking words to connect ideas (e.g. firstly, however, therefore, in addition).
- ✓ Keep your ideas focused on the topic.
- ✓ Check that your information flows logically from start to finish.

REMEMBER

A well-structured informative text is like a roadmap — it guides your reader through the information clearly and helps them reach a deeper understanding.



WHY STRUCTURE MATTERS



Helps readers understand complex ideas.



Keeps your writing focused and on track.



Makes your message clear, logical and convincing.



Improves reader engagement and retention.



Shows your writing skills and boosts credibility!



INFORMATIVE WRITING

Language Features

Informative writers choose their words carefully to explain ideas clearly, share facts and help the reader understand the topic.



KEY LANGUAGE FEATURES (WITH EXAMPLES)

1. TECHNICAL AND SUBJECT-SPECIFIC VOCABULARY



Uses precise terms related to the topic.

EXAMPLE:

The process of **photosynthesis** occurs in the **chloroplasts** of plant cells.

2. GENERALISATIONS



Uses general statements that are true in most cases.

EXAMPLE:

Most mammals give birth to live young and feed them milk.

3. FACTS AND STATISTICS



Includes facts, numbers and data to support ideas.

EXAMPLE:

Did you know that over **70%** of Earth's surface is covered by oceans?

4. DEFINITIONS



Explains the meaning of key terms.

EXAMPLE:

A **habitat** is the natural environment where a plant or animal lives.

5. CAUSE AND EFFECT LANGUAGE



Shows relationships between events or ideas.

EXAMPLE:

Because the rainforest is being cleared, many animal species are losing their habitat.

6. SEQUENCING WORDS AND PHRASES

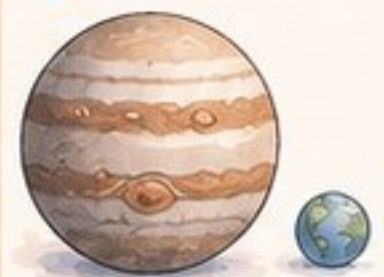


Helps the reader follow steps or the order of events.

EXAMPLE:

First, the egg hatches. **Next**, the caterpillar eats and grows. **Finally**, it forms a chrysalis.

7. COMPARATIVE LANGUAGE



Compares one thing with another.

EXAMPLE:

Jupiter is much **larger** than Earth; in fact, it is more than **11 times** wider.

8. MODAL VERBS AND PHRASES



Shows possibility, necessity or certainty.

EXAMPLE:

Scientists **may** find a way to reduce plastic pollution in the future.

9. CONNECTIVES AND TRANSITIONS



Links ideas and paragraphs to make the writing flow smoothly.

EXAMPLE:

Furthermore, this research shows that regular exercise improves mental health.

10. OBJECTIVE AND IMPERSONAL LANGUAGE



Uses a formal tone and avoids personal opinions.

EXAMPLE:

The experiment was conducted to observe the effects of light on plants.



TIPS FOR USING LANGUAGE FEATURES EFFECTIVELY



CHOOSE THE RIGHT WORDS

Use precise vocabulary that matches your topic and audience.



BE CLEAR AND CONCISE

Explain ideas clearly using simple, direct sentences.



SUPPORT YOUR IDEAS WITH EVIDENCE

Use facts, data and examples to build trust and credibility.



LINK YOUR IDEAS

Use connectives and transitions to guide the reader.



STAY OBJECTIVE

Focus on the facts rather than your own opinions or feelings.

WHY THESE FEATURES MATTER



They help your readers understand complex information more easily.



They make your writing more accurate, credible and trustworthy.



They keep your audience engaged and interested in your topic.



They show that you are a confident and capable writer!

INFORMATIVE WRITING

Annotated Exemplar

See how this informative text uses structure, language features and techniques to inform and explain.

The Great Barrier Reef: A Natural Wonder

TITLE

A clear and specific title tells the reader the topic.

INTRODUCTION

Introduces the topic and gives a general overview. It may include interesting or background information.

SUBHEADING

Breaks the text into sections and shows the main ideas.

FACTS AND DETAILS

Provides specific information, facts, examples and details to explain the ideas.

EXAMPLES AND EVIDENCE

Uses examples, statistics and real-life evidence to support the information.

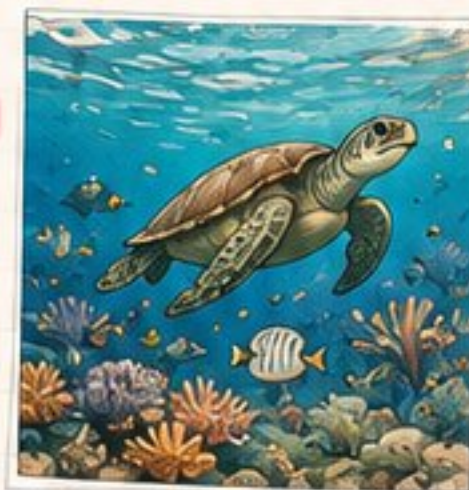
CONCLUSION

Summarises the key points and may end with a final thought or statement.

REFERENCE

Lists the sources used to research the information.

Stretching more than 2,300 kilometres along the coast of Queensland, Australia, the Great Barrier Reef is the largest coral reef system in the world. It is so big, it can be seen from space! This natural wonder is home to thousands of marine species and plays a vital role in the health of our oceans and our planet.



1. A Diverse and Unique Ecosystem

The Great Barrier Reef is made up of around 2,900 individual reefs and 900 islands. It supports an incredible variety of life. More than 1,500 species of fish, 400 types of coral, 4,000 kinds of molluscs and 6 of the world's 7 species of sea turtles all call it home. This amazing diversity makes the reef one of the most complex ecosystems on Earth.

2. Importance to the Environment

Coral reefs are often called the "rainforests of the sea" because they support such a wide range of life. The reef protects coastlines from storms and strong waves. It also helps maintain clean water by filtering out pollutants. In addition, the reef is a major source of food and income for many Australian communities through fishing and tourism.

3. Threats to the Reef

Unfortunately, the Great Barrier Reef is under threat. Climate change causes the ocean to warm, leading to coral bleaching. This happens when corals lose the colourful algae that live in them and can even cause them to die. Pollution from land, overfishing and crown-of-thorns starfish outbreaks also damage the reef. If these threats are not managed, the future of this natural wonder is at risk.

4. Protecting Our Natural Treasure

There is still hope for the Great Barrier Reef. Scientists, governments and local communities are working together to protect it. Marine parks have been created, and laws are in place to reduce pollution and overfishing. Everyone can help by using less plastic, saving water and learning more about this incredible place.

The Great Barrier Reef is more than just a beautiful place to visit – it is a vital part of our natural world. By understanding its importance and taking action to protect it, we can help ensure that future generations continue to enjoy this breathtaking wonder.

References

- Great Barrier Reef Marine Park Authority. (2023). *About the Reef*.
- Australian Institute of Marine Science. (2022). *Reef Facts*.
- World Wildlife Fund Australia. (2023). *Threats to the Reef*.



LANGUAGE FEATURES IN ACTION



TECHNICAL VOCABULARY

Uses precise and topic-specific words.
Example: ecosystem, coral bleaching, molluscs



FACTS AND STATISTICS

Includes numbers and data to add accuracy.
Example: "2,900 reefs", "1,500 species of fish"



DESCRIPTIVE LANGUAGE

Uses adjectives and descriptive phrases to help readers picture the information.
Example: "colourful algae", "breath-taking wonder"



CAUSE AND EFFECT

Explains reasons and results.
Example: "The ocean warms, leading to coral bleaching."



CONNECTIVES

Links ideas and helps the text flow.
Example: furthermore, in addition, however, if these threats...



PRESENT TENSE

Uses present tense to state facts and general truths.
Example: "The reef protects coastlines."



THIRD PERSON

Writes in third person to keep the text objective.
Example: "Scientists are working together."

WHAT MAKES THIS TEXT EFFECTIVE?



Clear structure makes it easy to follow.



Facts and evidence make it trustworthy.



Varied language keeps the reader interested.



Each section focuses on one main idea.



It informs and encourages positive action.

WRITER'S TIP

Plan your information first, use headings and subheadings, choose strong facts and words, and always think about what your reader needs to know!

REMEMBER:

Good informative texts are clear, accurate, organised and easy to understand.